

Module 00

VS Code Optional

COURSE	AI Workshop 2.0, Desktop Edition
AUTHOR	Danny McMillan, Seller Sessions
YOU NEED	A Mac or PC and a paid Claude plan

WHY -- Why This Matters

Before you can use AI tools, you need a workspace that's set up properly. VS Code is that workspace. GitHub Copilot is the tool that sets it up for you.

Important framing: Copilot is your **setup tool**. It installs extensions, configures your theme, and gets VS Code ready. From Module 1 onwards, **Claude Code CLI** is the main tool you'll use for building.

Think of it this way:

- **Copilot** = The person who sets up your desk on day one
- **Claude Code** = The colleague who works alongside you every day

WHAT -- What You'll Learn

How to use Copilot to configure a complete AI-powered workspace in under 10 minutes.

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'dark', 'themeVariables': {'nodeTextColor': '#e8e8e8',  
'primaryTextColor': '#e8e8e8', 'secondaryTextColor': '#cccccc', 'tertiaryTextColor':  
'#cccccc', 'clusterBkg': 'transparent', 'clusterBorder': '#8b949e'}}}%  
flowchart LR  
    A["Install<br/>VS Code"] --> B["Install<br/>Copilot"]  
    B --> C["Give Copilot<br/>self-drive file"]  
    C --> D["Copilot installs<br/>6 extensions"]  
    D --> E["Workspace<br/>ready"]  
  
style A fill:none,stroke:#8b949e,stroke-width:1px,color:#c9d1d9  
style B fill:none,stroke:#8b949e,stroke-width:1px,color:#c9d1d9  
style C fill:none,stroke:#8b949e,stroke-width:1px,color:#c9d1d9  
style D fill:none,stroke:#8b949e,stroke-width:1px,color:#c9d1d9  
style E fill:none,stroke:#58a6ff,stroke-width:2px,color:#c9d1d9
```

The 6 Extensions (hardcoded -- no more, no less)

#	EXTENSION ID	WHAT IT DOES
1	github.copilot	AI coding assistant (free tier: 100 tasks/month)
2	github.copilot-chat	Copilot chat panel inside VS Code
3	anthropic.claude-code	Claude Code -- the main AI tool from Module 1
4	akamud.vscode-theme-onedark	One Dark theme (easy on the eyes)
5	cweijan.vscode-office	View PDFs, markdown (WYSIWYG), and xlsx files
6	yzhang.markdown-all-in-one	Markdown shortcuts + table of contents

What You Need Before Starting

- VS Code installed (free from code.visualstudio.com)
- A GitHub account (free)

- Internet connection

HOW -- The Self-Drive Process

Same cycle as every module:

- 1. **You read** this README (done)
- 2. **You give Copilot the self-drive file** -- open `COPILLOT-SELF-DRIVE.md` , copy the contents, paste into Copilot Chat
- 3. **Copilot builds** -- it installs all 6 extensions, sets your theme, and verifies everything works

Making VS Code Feel Like Home

Once Copilot finishes the setup, these four tweaks make VS Code feel less like a code editor:

- 1. **Theme** -- One Dark is already installed. If you want something different, Command Palette (Cmd+Shift+P) -> "Color Theme"
- 2. **File icons** -- The Office extension gives you familiar icons for PDFs, spreadsheets, etc.
- 3. **Sidebar** -- Pin your project folder in the Explorer. Hide panels you don't use
- 4. **Font size** -- Cmd+Plus (Mac) / Ctrl+Plus (Windows) to zoom in until it feels comfortable

When it's personalised, it stops feeling like software and starts feeling like home.

Quick Reference

WHAT	WHERE
Copilot Chat	Sidebar: Cmd+Shift+I (Mac) / Ctrl+Shift+I (Windows)
Command Palette	Cmd+Shift+P (Mac) / Ctrl+Shift+P (Windows)
Settings	Cmd+, (Mac) / Ctrl+, (Windows)
Agent Mode	Switch in Copilot chat dropdown menu

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	FIX
Copilot won't install	Update VS Code to latest version, check GitHub sign-in

PROBLEM	FIX
Can't authenticate	Click "Sign in" when prompted, approve in browser, return to VS Code
Extensions not appearing	Make sure you're in Agent mode, restart VS Code
Also see <code>COPILLOT-CHEATSHEET.pdf</code> in this folder for a full troubleshooting guide.	

WHAT IF -- What This Unlocks

Your workspace is now ready for the real work. From here:

- **Module 000** -- Install Claude Code CLI (the tool that does the heavy lifting)
- **Module 1** -- Create your `CLAUDE.md` file (custom instructions for Claude Code)
- **Module 2** -- Set up a Master Log (session continuity)
- **Module 3** -- Slash commands, skills, and Plan Mode (speed and control)
- **Module 4** -- MCPs (connect Claude to external services)
- **Module 5** -- AI agents (autonomous specialists)

Copilot stays available for quick tasks, but Claude Code is where the power is.

Module 00 | AI Workshop Curriculum | SSL 2026